

NATIONAL CYBER CRIME REPORTING PORAL UNDER WOMEN/CHILDREN RELATED CRIME

This portal is an initiative of Government of India to facilitate victims/complainants to report cybercrime complaints online. This portal caters to complaints pertaining to cybercrimes only with special focus on cybercrimes against women and children. Complaints reported on this portal are dealt by law enforcement agencies/ police based on the information available in the complaints. It is imperative to provide correct and accurate details while filing complaint for prompt action.

Please contact local police in case of an emergency or for reporting crimes other than cybercrimes. National police helpline number is 112. National women helpline number is 181 and Cyber Crime Helpline is 1930.

CYBER CRIME MEANING

Cybercrime can be defined as unlawful activities conducted through the internet and digital devices intending to creep into the private space of others and disturb them with objectionable content and misbehavior.

Internet surfing has become a regular practice for educational, social, entertainment, or professional purposes in today's digital world. Women have been working or learning using online platforms and frequently accessing social media platforms.

While most people are engaged on the internet and other digital platforms for various educational and recreational purposes, many miscreants use these digital tools to abuse and bully online users, especially women. This type of criminal activity is called Cybercrime, as it involves using cyberspace.

CYBER CRIME AGAINST WOMEN

Cyber violence uses Computer Technology to access women's personal information and use the internet for harassment and exploitation. Women are becoming soft targets as they often trust other people and are unaware of the consequences.

Cyber crime has increased because it is seldom reported and difficult to detect and prove. Cyber crime is away from traditional monitoring, investigation, or audit and requires specialists to understand the nature of the crime.

Cyber crime affects women the most by subjecting them to mental and emotional harassment. Most women become distressed, humiliated, and depressed under this type of crime which is challenging to address and resolve.

CYBER CRIME TYPES

Cyber crime against women includes gender-based and sexual remarks and activities performed through a computer network or mobile phones, affecting the dignity of women and causing emotional distress.

The different types of cybercrime against women are explained as follows:

- **Cyber Stalking:** It includes attempting to contact women via social networking sites without any legitimate purpose, putting threatening messages on the chat

page, and constantly disturbing the victims with objectionable emails and messages to create mental distress.

- **Cyber Defamation:** This activity involves defaming the victim through blackmailing and disclosing their details or modified pictures. It often involves extorting and seeking sexual favors from the victim.
- **Cyber Hacking:** When asked to click on unauthorised URLs or download apps that leak all their personal information on their phones, the women became victims of cyber hacking. The criminals utilise these details for unauthorised monetary transactions and other unlawful activities.
- **Cyber Bullying:** It is an act of regular harassment and bullying of the victim through the digital communication device by posting abusive and misleading content, pictures, or videos and sending rape and death threats.
- **Pornography:** This criminal activity involves posting morphed images of victims and using them for pornographic purposes, sometimes demanding money to remove them from social networking sites.
- **Cyber Grooming:** In this case, a person builds a relationship with a woman through an online platform and pressurizes her for undue favors or doing sexual act.

HOW TO TACKLE CYBER CRIME

The most important part is to have a thorough knowledge and awareness about privacy and cybercrimes to avoid people being vulnerable to such threats. There must be more education on cybercrimes and online fraud and how to get rid of or handle them. Cyber literacy should start from the basic level with adequate knowledge about good operating practices.

It is necessary to remain extra vigilant about cyber privacy and security. Proper awareness and education can help teach good habits and techniques while working online with digital devices. There has been an increasing trend in cyber crime against women involving blackmailing, fake profiles, morphed images, and publishing or transmitting sexually explicit messages online.

MEASURES FOR CYBER SAFETY

These are some of the measures that can be taken to protect oneself from cyber crimes:

- Keep a watch on irrelevant or fraudulent messages or emails.
- Avoid responding to emails asking for personal information.
- Avoid accessing fraudulent websites or apps that require personal information.
- Take care of the email address and password.
- Use strong and secure passwords and keep on changing them regularly.
- Don't click on unrecognized UPL or download unknown apps.
- Remain updated about cyber laws and policies.

CYBER LAWS FOR WOMEN SAFETY

All users of cyberspace are subject to specific laws applicable worldwide. Cyber laws deal with legal issues arising from networked computer technology and digital platforms. These laws protect the victims against cyber crimes and help them address the issues and get justice. The following **acts under the Indian Penal Code (IPC, 1860) section 354** mention the following crimes as punishable under the law.

- **Section 354A:** Demand for sexual favors or displaying objectionable pictures against a woman's consent or making sexual remarks and sexual harassment will cause imprisonment of up to 3 years with fines.
- **Section 354C:** An act of photographing or publishing a picture of a woman engaged in a private act without her consent will lead to imprisonment of 3 to 7 years.
- **Section 354D:** Contacting a woman online and sending irrelevant emails/messages despite the woman's evident disinterest will cause imprisonment of 5 years with fines.

The Information Technology Act of 2000 also has provisions for punishment under the following sections:

- **Section 66C-**Identify cyber hacking is a punishable offense with imprisonment of 3 years and fines of Rs. 1 lakh.
- **Section 66E-** Deals with the offense of capturing, publishing, or sending pictures of women in circumstances that violate privacy. This causes imprisonment of 3 years.
- **Section 67A-** Makes it illegal to publish and transmit sexually explicit content and is punishable with imprisonment of up to 5 to 7 years.

The Cyber Crime Prevention Act of 2012 focuses on preventing and prosecuting offenders involved in cyber crimes like violating privacy, confidentiality, and integrity of information through computer-related criminal activities.

The Indecent Representation of Women (Prohibition) Act regulates and prohibits the indecent representation of women through the media and publications, which also includes the audio-visual media, the content in electronic form, and distribution of material on the Internet and the portrayal of women over the web.

CYBER SECURITY NA GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

The Cyber Crime Prevention against Women and Children (CCPWC) scheme is introduced to develop effective measures to handle cyber crimes against women and children in India. It allows a cybercrime victim to file a complaint through an online cybercrime reporting platform.

The platform also provides details of law enforcement and regulatory agencies at the local and national levels. The CCPWC also conducts awareness programs starting from the school level as a proactive measure to mitigate cyber crimes.

PREVENTING CYBER CRIME AGAINST WOMEN

The most important part is to have a thorough knowledge and awareness about privacy and cyber crimes to avoid people being vulnerable to such threats. There has to be more education on cyber crimes and online fraud and how to get rid of them or handle them.

Cyber literacy should start from the basic level with adequate knowledge about good operating practices. It is necessary to remain extra vigilant about cyber privacy and security. Proper awareness and education can help teach good habits and practices while working online with digital devices.

There is also a need for stricter law enforcement and punishment for offenders. Media interventions for creating public awareness can make an effective contribution in bringing about changes in the attitudes of people towards gender norms.

CYBER VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN -DATA

Here is some important data on cyber harassment of women in India:

- A total of 10,405 cyber crimes against women were reported in 2020, with an increase of 24%.
- The Information Technology Act of 2000 is the primary law in India dealing with cyber crime.

KEEP THIS INFORMATION READY BEFORE FILING YOUR COMPLAINT:

MANDATORY INFORMATION

1. Incident Date and Time.
2. Incident details (minimum 200 characters) without any special characters (#\$%^*''~|!).
3. Soft copy of any national Id (Voter Id, Driving license, Passport, PAN Card, Aadhar Card) of complainant in .jpeg, .jpg, .png format (file size should not more than 5 MB).
4. In case of financial fraud, please keep following information ready:
 - i) Name of the Bank/ Wallet/Merchant
 - ii) 12-digit Transaction id/UTR No.
 - iii) Date of transaction
 - iv) Fraud amount
5. Soft copy of all the relevant evidences related to the cyber crime (not more than 10 MB each)

Optional/Desirable Information:

1. Suspected website URLs/ Social Media handles (wherever applicable)
2. Suspect Details (if available)
 - i) Mobile No
 - ii) Email id
 - iii) Bank Account No
 - iv) Address
 - v) Soft copy of photograph of suspect in .jpeg, .jpg, .png format (not more than 5 MB)
 - vi) Any other document through which suspect can be identified.

Here are the steps for a woman to file a complaint on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, specifically for cybercrimes related to online harassment, stalking, or abuse:

1. Visit the website <https://cybercrime.gov.in/>
2. Click on the "Cyber Crime Reporting" link.
3. Read the instructions carefully and click on "Report Now".
4. Select the appropriate category of cybercrime, such as "Online Sexual Abuse/Harassment" or "Cyberstalking/Cyberbullying".
5. Fill in all the required personal details, including name, email, mobile number, and address.
6. In the "Incident Details" section, provide a detailed description of the cybercrime incident, including:
 - The nature of the harassment or abuse (e.g., unwanted messages, non-consensual sharing of intimate images/videos, cyberstalking, etc.)
 - Dates, times, and any specific incidents or events
 - Names or identifying details of the perpetrator(s), if known
 - Any threats, intimidation, or emotional distress caused by the harassment

7. Upload any supporting documents, evidence, or screenshots in the "Upload Documents" section. This may include:

- Screenshots of abusive or threatening messages, emails, or social media posts
- Recordings or copies of any audio/video content shared without consent
- Any other relevant evidence or documentation

8. If the harassment or abuse involves the non-consensual sharing of intimate images or videos, explicitly mention this in the complaint and provide details of the platforms or channels where the content was shared.

9. Review the details carefully and click on "Submit" to file the complaint.

10. Note down the complaint reference number for future reference.

It's important to act promptly and report any form of online harassment, stalking, or abuse. Provide as much detail and evidence as possible to assist the authorities in investigating the matter effectively.

The National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal takes complaints of cybercrimes against women very seriously. The authorities will review the case and may contact the complainant for further details or clarification if required.

Remember, filing a complaint is an important step in seeking justice and preventing further harassment or abuse. Do not hesitate to report any cybercrime incidents, as prompt action can help protect both the victim and prevent the perpetrator from targeting others.

NATIONAL CYBER CRIME REPORTING PORTAL

Steps to file a complaint at the Cybercrime portal related to women and children
ANONYMOUSLY

1. Visit the Cyber Crime Portal website (cybercrime.gov.in).

2. Under the Women and Children Section, click on the "Register ANONYMOUSLY" button/link.

3. Read the given instructions carefully and click "File a Complaint."

4. Accept the Privacy Policies and the Terms, then click "I Accept."

5. Fill out the form with the following details as mentioned:

- **Category of complaint** : This field includes the following categories
 - Child Pornography (CP)-Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM)
 - Rape/Gang Rape (RGR)-Sexually Abusive Content
 - Publishing or Transmitting Sexually Obscene material in electronic form
 - Publishing or transmitting of material containing sexually explicit act in electronic form
- **Approximate date & time of Incident/receiving/viewing of content**
- **Reason for delay in reporting**
- **State / UTs**
- **District**

- Police Station

Where did the incident occur? This field includes the following platforms:

- Instagram (for this, mention the Instagram ID and date of the post)
- Snapchat (for this, mention the Snapchat ID)
- Twitter (for this, mention the Twitter ID)
- WhatsApp (for this, mention the Suspect's WhatsApp number)
- Website URL (for this, mention the URL/Link of the website)
- YouTube (for this, mention the YouTube Video link)
- LinkedIn (for this, mention the LinkedIn handle)
- Telegram (for this, mention the Telegram handle)
- **Supporting Evidence** (file format includes image and PDF). This field includes a screenshot of the suspect's social media page.

- Please provide any additional information about the incident

Next, fill out the Suspect Details, keeping in mind **not to share the suspect's mobile number in other fields.**

This section includes the following fields:

- Name of the suspect
- One identity of the suspect from the following identities:
 - Driving License
 - Email
 - Gov. Issued Card
 - Mobile Number
 - PAN Card
 - Voter Card
 - Bank Account Number
- One Photograph of the suspect (maximum size of the photo is 5MB)
- Any other related details

Finally, review all the given details and check the "I Agree" button.

Click "Confirm and Submit."

FOR TRACKING THE PROCESS OF THE COMPLAINT. CLICK THE “REGISTER & TRACK” OPTION.

Fill out the Citizen Login Form

Here generally the Login ID is the Email Id and Mobile No. provided by the user.